

Pragya Aryal

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Recent Computer Science graduate with experience in project management, digital communication, research, and data analysis, working at the intersection of technology, storytelling, and social impact. Interested in working in people-centered projects in R&D, project management, and data analytics.

Experience

New York City Department of Transportation (DOT)

New York City, USA

Intern | CityGAP Fellow

Feb 2026 – Present (until May 2026)

- Serve as point person with the New York City Department of Transportation Urban Design Team on the Street Design Manual Gamification Project in collaboration with the Living City Project
- Coordinate and lead meetings with multiple stakeholders to support game design development
- Manage and guide Living City Project gap year students through the game development process as Project Manager
- Support communications and outreach for the NYCxDesign event organized by NYC DOT

Living City Project

New York City, USA

CityGAP Student | Gap Semester Program

Sept 2025 – Dec 2025

- Served as Project Manager for a group project conducted in partnership with the New York City Department of Transportation (NYC DOT), leading reporting on public spaces and neighborhood biography in the South Bronx by integrating urban history, community context, interviews, and field observations.
- Wrote an individual comparative policy memo analyzing public spaces in New York City and Kathmandu, drawing recommendations to create more inclusive and accessible public spaces in Nepal.
- Managed semester-long social media content and collaborations, supporting program engagement and documenting project work and city explorations.

Sumana Shrestha Secretariat

Kathmandu, Nepal

(Secretariat of the Member of Parliament/Former Education Minister of Nepal)

Digital Communication Fellow

Jan 2023 – August 2025

- Created and managed branding and content, growing TikTok and Instagram to 100K+ organic followers over 2+ years.
- Engaged youth audiences in political discussions, with over 80% of followers under 30.
- Simplified complex political jargon into relatable content to increase youth engagement.
- Shared updates on proposed bills and amendments across social media and gathered public feedback.
- Researched political trends and collaborated with cross-functional teams to align communication and branding across digital platforms.

Shethekranti

Nepal

(Feminist Campaign led by young women in Nepal)

Collaborative Team Member | Website Developer

Apr 2023 – Jun 2025

- Developed, designed and hosted the official website.
- Conducted sustainable pad-making sessions and sexual health education workshops in schools of Parsa, Nepal.
- Conducted sessions on harassment, bullying, and mental health in Kathmandu schools and Aama Samuha in Damauli, Nepal.
- Actively engaging in team meetings to plan for workshops, events, and plans.
- Generating content to raise awareness on topics like HIV/AIDS, PCOs, and Queer issues through digital platforms.

Women in Information and Technology (WIIT)

Kathmandu, Nepal

Data Enumerator (Research Project with The Asia Foundation)

Mar 2024 – Apr 2024

- Collected and compiled organizational and individual data for the research study “Women in ICTs: Current Status and Work Provisions in Nepal”
- Engaged with diverse participants respectfully and effectively under tight deadlines
- Contributed to data that supports impactful policymaking and research outcomes
- Adapted to on-ground challenges and ensured accuracy and integrity of field data

Afristem

Capetown, South Africa

Apprentice | Curriculum Developer lead

Sept 2023 - Dec 2023

- Developed a beginner-friendly Scratch e-book tailored for middle school students in low-income areas.
- Led the project of designing a comprehensive 12-hour web development module and its teaching manual, aimed at assisting high school and college graduates in securing jobs in frontend development
- Designed the organization's logo, email signature, and letterhead.
- Initiated and managed social media platforms (Instagram, LinkedIn).
- Launched Instagram with 9 posts, gaining 80+ followers and over 300% engagement in a month.

Education

Herald College Kathmandu

Affiliated with University of Wolverhampton, UK

BSC Computer Science (Hons)

Kathmandu, Nepal

2022 - 2025

Certifications

CURIEA – *Representative Youth Consultation for Informed Advocacy* — 2024

Emergent Future Fellowship – *Fellow, Initiatives Of Change, Panchgani, Pune India* — January 20-27, 2025

SACHI – *Seeking Authenticity through Challenging Mis/Disinformation Bootcamp* — February 25–28, 2025

Young Politicians Course – *Political Leadership Program* — March 7–9, 2025

Skills

Language: English, Nepali & Hindi (Working level proficiency)

Other: Research, Storytelling, Digital communication & Branding, Data analysis, Website development

Technical: HTML, JS, SQL, Python, Figma